

Black hat methods might seem easy to implement in the beginning, but one should remember that by going against the rules, they are only pitting themselves against the largest, smartest and fastest workforces on the planet—the search engines!

Yes, it is about writing smart code, but eventually, the complexity and the work hours it demands would easily outweigh the net revenue earned.

6.2 White Hat Blogging

Now, about the Good Guy's methods. Even the name here draws a parallel, as these techniques are classified as White Hat Search Engine Optimization. White hat methods of SEO involve following the search engines' guidelines as to what is and what isn't acceptable. Their advice generally is:

- Create content for the user, not the search engines.
- Make that content easily accessible to their spiders, and to not try to game the system.

Often, webmasters make critical mistakes when designing or setting up their sites, inadvertently “poisoning” them so that they will not rank well. White hat SEOs attempt to discover and correct mistakes, such as machine-unreadable menus, broken links, temporary redirects, or poor navigation structure. Because search engines are text-centric, many of the same methods that are useful for Web accessibility are also advantageous for SEO.

A detailed case for this common ground, cited by the W3C with respect to Developing a Web Accessibility Business Case, is *SEO—A Positive Influence on Web Accessibility*. Google has brought the relationship between SEO and accessibility even closer with the release of Google Accessible Web Search which prioritises better-accessible sites.